MS in Computer Science GRE Policy & Score Tracker

Top 30 US CS Department Policy Tracker, Quant Cutoffs, Research Alignment & Application Tiering

1. Top US MS Computer Science Department GRE Policy Matrix

Verify official departmental GRE expectations across elite US Computer Science institutions.

University /	Current GRE Policy	Competitive Quant	Verbal / AWA	Admission Weighting
Carnegie Mellon University (SCS)	Optional / Recommended	168 - 170	156+ | AWA 4.0	High (Quant is strict filter for systems/AI tracks)
Stanford University (CS MS)	Optional / Considered	169 - 170	158+ | AWA 4.0	Holistic (Strong research / publications trump score)
University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign	Required / Strongly Encouraged	167 - 170	154+ | AWA 3.5	High (Departmental filter for technical rigor)
Georgia Institute of Technology (MS CS)	Required	166 - 169	155+ | AWA 3.5	Moderate (High GPA + Quant score essential)
University of Washington (Allen School)	Not Considered (Blind)	N/A	N/A	Evaluated 100% on research, coding & recommendations
Purdue University (CS)	Required	165 - 168	153+ | AWA 3.5	High (Threshold requirement for TA/RA funding)

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE: Rule of Thumb: For competitive MS CS admissions, any Quant score below 166 represents an application risk.

2. Profile Balancing: When Quant Compensates for Low GPA

How standardized test scores interact with undergraduate pedigree and technical research.

Undergraduate GPA Tier	Research / Publications	Target GRE Quant Score	Strategic Application Advice
Low GPA (< 3.2 / 7.5 CGPA)	Limited / No Papers	169 - 170 (95th+ %ile)	Mandatory to take GRE; a near-perfect Quant proves technical capability
Low GPA (< 3.2 / 7.5 CGPA)	Strong (NeurIPS, CVPR, IEEE)	166 - 168	Focus application narrative on research impact; Quant validates fundamentals
High GPA (> 3.7 / 8.8 CGPA)	Top National University	166+	GRE confirms transcript; apply to top-10 programs with confidence
Non-CS Engineering Background	Self-taught coder / IT worker	168 - 170	Quant score proves mathematical maturity for advanced CS algorithms

STRATEGIC PRINCIPLE: Scholarship Note: Teaching Assistantships (TA) often enforce strict AWA >= 4.0 and Verbal >= 155 minimums.

3. 8-Week Quant-Focused Preparation Roadmap for CS Applicants

Engineers need speed and trap-avoidance rather than basic math remediation.

- Weeks 1-2: Advanced Algebra & Discrete Math. Drill permutations, combinatorics, probability, and integer properties.
- Weeks 3-4: Quantitative Comparison Trap Elimination. Master number line plugging (fractions, negative integers, zero, decimals).
- Weeks 5-6: Pacing Sprint Modules. Solve 20-question sets in 30 minutes (enforcing a strict 1.5 min/question ceiling).
- Weeks 7-8: Full Simulation & Error Log Audit. Complete 3 Official ETS PowerPrep Plus exams; ensure zero careless errors.